Hilprecht 1910 — *The Earliest Version of the Babylonian Deluge Story*

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- **Title:** The Earliest Version of the Babylonian Deluge Story and the Temple Library of Nippur (Babylonian Expedition of the University of Pennsylvania, Series D, vol. V, fasc. 1)
- **Author:** H. V. Hilprecht. Philadelphia: University of Pennsylvania, 1910.
- **URLs:** https://archive.org/details/ldpd_11899184_000 (Columbia University Libraries scan, 92 pp.) ; https://archive.org/details/babylonianexped01archgoog (Google/U. Michigan scan, 281 images — bound volume containing this fascicle, image-only PDF).
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-16
- **License: Public domain** (US 1910; archive.org `NOT_IN_COPYRIGHT`).

Files

- `Hilprecht-1910--archive.org-ldpd_11899184_000.pdf` — Columbia scan with text layer.
- `Hilprecht-1910--archive.org-ldpd-djvu-OCR.txt` — OCR text of the Columbia scan (search aid; transliteration diacritics unreliable).
- `Hilprecht-1910--archive.org-babylonianexped01archgoog.pdf` — Google scan (backup; includes the autographed plate).

Contents

Edition (transliteration, translation, photo and autograph plate "at the end of the book") of the **Nippur fragment CBS 13532** (= Lambert & Millard / Wasserman Ms. **J**, MB; Hilprecht dated it c. 2100 BC). The fragment contains Ea's instructions to build the boat ("...a great ship build... let its name be 'Preserver of life'").

Line numbering

Hilprecht's obverse/reverse line numbers (the sides are now inverted relative to modern editions: Hilprecht's "Reverse" is the inscribed flood passage). Modern numbering: Wasserman 2020 "J" lines; eBL CBS.13532 `@reverse 1'–14'`.

Assessment

Of historical value only (plate/photo still useful; transliteration and dating are outdated, and the book's treatment of the "temple library" is controversial). For the text use Wasserman 2020 / SEAL no. 1562 / eBL `CBS.13532.atf`.